

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Aviation English



Teacher's guide

Teach practical workplace communication with specific cases, clear language targets, and a repeatable feedback process.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For aviation operations managers, airline staff, maintenance coordinators, safety teams, dispatchers, airport operations staff, ground handlers, and aviation-adjacent professionals.

Workplace coordination English. This course does not teach radiotelephony phraseology or certify aviation language proficiency; operational communication follows approved aviation procedures.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Safety Culture and Stop-Work Authority

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

02 Operations Control and Dispatch Coordination

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

03 Maintenance Deferrals and MEL Language

Clarify missing information before responding.

04 Irregular Operations and Passenger Communication

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

05 Ground Handling and Turnaround Performance

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

06 Security and Access Control

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

07 Incident Reporting and Investigation

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

08 Regulatory Audits and Readiness

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop to choose a vocabulary, grammar, role-play, or new-dialogue activity.

A 60-minute lesson that works

Prepare the case and the learner pages. Keep the model response hidden until learners have attempted their own. Choose two field terms that are important to understanding the case.

0-5 minutes | Activate experience

Ask learners to name a comparable situation without sharing confidential details. Introduce the communication goal.

5-12 minutes | Read and sort facts

Read the case. Learners identify confirmed facts, unknowns, the audience, and the immediate communication need.

12-22 minutes | Notice and practice language

Explain the workshop pattern. Work through the vocabulary and editing example, then discuss both language checks and the reasons behind the choices.

22-35 minutes | 05 • Conversations

Read one ten-turn conversation aloud, notice a useful expression, then compare the other two. Identify each speaker's purpose and how the exchange ends.

35-47 minutes | 06 • Say it

Rehearse both speaking scenarios from the workbook. Give two minutes of preparation, switch roles, and use the success checks. Add the complication only after a successful first round.

47-55 minutes | Compare and revise

Reveal the model. Discuss alternative acceptable wording. Give one meaning correction and one language correction, then repeat.

55-60 minutes | Retrieve and transfer

Close the materials. Learners recall two expressions and identify one communication habit to use in another situation.

Adapt the session

For 45 minutes, study one complete conversation and rehearse one scenario; assign the others for oral follow-up. For 90 minutes, rehearse all three conversations and give both scenarios a second round. More time should produce more meaningful practice, not longer explanations.

LESSON 01 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Safety Culture and Stop-Work Authority

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

CASE

In a ground-operations language exercise, a team member sees a possible hazard near equipment. The local safety process applies.

Teach this move

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Vocabulary to check: safety management system, hazard, stop work, reporting culture.

Model response

I see a possible hazard near the equipment. Please alert the responsible person and follow the local safety process. I'll state the location and observation clearly so the concern can be assessed.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Second-round challenge

The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Language-check answers

1. B - Send it no later than Thursday. 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.
2. A - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review? The requested action and information are explicit.

05 · Conversations

1. Request a hazard review near the cart - Fictional ground-operations language simulation, not operational phraseology: a worker observes loose material near a service cart; local safety procedures govern all actions.
2. A report needs an owner - Separate fictional safety-management exercise: a training report about poor lighting was submitted yesterday but has no assigned reviewer; no operational clearance is being discussed.

3. Make space for a contractor's concern - Separate fictional induction exercise: a contractor reports that a briefing diagram is unreadable; the team has not started the represented task.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A missing report acknowledgment

In a fictional safety exercise, a staff member submitted a hazard report this morning and received no acknowledgment. The hazard's assessment status is unknown. Ask the safety coordinator to confirm receipt and identify the follow-up owner.

Role A: Ground services employee: make a precise request without assuming the report was ignored.

Role B: Safety coordinator: agree to check receipt and ownership, without promising a technical outcome.

Possible opening: Could you check whether my hazard report was received and who is handling the follow-up?

Success checks

- Separate missing acknowledgment from confirmed inaction.
- Ask for receipt and ownership checks.
- Keep actual safety actions within the applicable local process.

Add a complication: A colleague suggests submitting the same report repeatedly until someone replies.

LESSON 02 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Operations Control and Dispatch Coordination

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

CASE

An operations update has a provisional aircraft assignment and an unresolved crew-status question. A draft message calls the plan confirmed.

Teach this move

Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

Vocabulary to check: dispatch, crew legality, aircraft routing, delay code.

Model response

The aircraft assignment is provisional, and crew status still needs confirmation. I'll distinguish those open items from confirmed information in the operations update.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision gives observable progress. A positive label alone does not tell the reader what is complete or still needed.

Second-round challenge

The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Language-check answers

1. A - The team has completed the review. 'Has completed' states that the action is finished.
2. C - Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it. This explicitly labels the date as planned and identifies the missing confirmation.

05 • Conversations

1. Aircraft assigned provisionally - Fictional operations-control briefing: aircraft routing is provisional and crew status remains unresolved; this is workplace English, not dispatch authorization.

2. A revised route has not reached every team - Separate fictional coordination case: a revised aircraft-routing document is approved for internal planning, but station receipt is unconfirmed; no flight-release decision is involved.

3. Separate the completed review from the open question - Separate fictional desk exercise: a delay summary's timestamps have been checked, but the reason classification remains under review.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | An update with two versions

A fictional station has received routing plan version 4, while a coordination slide still displays version 3. Version 4 is a planning proposal; aircraft and crew confirmation remain open. Give a brief status correction.

Role A: Operations planner: state which document has been received and what remains provisional.

Role B: Station manager: ask what can be shared internally without implying a confirmed operation.

Possible opening: The station has received version 4, but the slide still shows version 3 and neither is flight authorization.

Success checks

- Identify the version discrepancy.
- Distinguish receipt from completed operational checks.
- Preserve the provisional aircraft and crew status.

Add a complication: A colleague calls document receipt proof that all coordination checks are complete.

LESSON 03 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Maintenance Deferrals and MEL Language

Clarify missing information before responding.

CASE

A maintenance coordination note mentions a deferral but omits the relevant reference and authorized status.

Teach this move

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Vocabulary to check: MEL, logbook, deferred maintenance, airworthiness.

Model response

Could you confirm the reference and current authorized status with maintenance control? I need accurate coordination information; I cannot infer airworthiness from an incomplete note.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Second-round challenge

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Language-check answers

1. C - Could you confirm when the review starts? The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".
2. B - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review? This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

05 • Conversations

1. Which deferral reference? - Fictional maintenance coordination exercise: a note says deferred but lacks a reference and authorized status; no equipment decision is made in this dialogue.
2. Closed message, open logbook question - Separate fictional case: a coordination ticket says closed, but the linked logbook extract is incomplete. Staff must clarify record meaning, not decide airworthiness.

3. A date without a label - Separate fictional language case: a maintenance summary contains a date beside a deferral, but no field label or source reference.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Two summaries use different status words

In a fictional maintenance-record exercise, one summary says reviewed and another says deferred for the same entry. The original logbook and authorized status are unavailable. Ask the record owner to clarify the difference.

Role A: Operations liaison: identify both words and request the original supporting record.

Role B: Records coordinator: explain that you cannot infer operational permission from the summaries.

Possible opening: Could you clarify why the same entry is described as reviewed in one summary and deferred in the other?

Success checks

- Identify the precise terminology conflict.
- Request the original reference and authorized status.
- Avoid selecting a status for convenience or inferring airworthiness.

Add a complication: The liaison is asked to choose whichever description causes less disruption.

LESSON 04 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Irregular Operations and Passenger Communication

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

CASE

Passengers receive conflicting messages about a delay. The next departure estimate has not been confirmed.

Teach this move

Name what was unclear or wrong, acknowledge its effect, and correct it. A brief apology can help, followed by a practical next step. Avoid explaining away the other person's reaction or promising an outcome you cannot control.

Vocabulary to check: IROP, reaccommodation, misconnect, weather delay.

Model response

I'm sorry for the conflicting information. We are waiting for a confirmed update from the responsible team. I'll share the next verified information and explain the available assistance through our process.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision takes responsibility for the message without blaming the listener. It identifies what needs to be corrected.

Second-round challenge

The listener remains disappointed after the correction. Acknowledge the impact and restate the available next step calmly.

Language-check answers

1. B - I'm sorry my earlier wording was unclear. This acknowledges the speaker's contribution to the problem.
2. A - The corrected date and the current confirmation status. A repair needs usable corrected information, including any uncertainty.

05 • Conversations

1. Correcting the unconfirmed departure estimate - Fictional irregular-operations case: gate and app messages conflict; the next departure estimate is unconfirmed. A gate supervisor briefs a tour representative.

2. A hotel request was mistaken for a booking - Separate fictional IROP case: an agent told a travel coordinator that hotel accommodation was arranged, but the record shows only a submitted request.

3. Weather delay versus unknown cause - Separate fictional case: a customer-service draft attributes a delay to weather, but operations has confirmed only that a delay exists, not its cause.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A connection review is not a new ticket

A fictional service agent's message says rebooked, but the case record shows only that a connection review was opened. No alternative flight is confirmed. Correct the information in a call with a corporate travel arranger.

Role A: Passenger services supervisor: acknowledge the inaccurate status and give the verified review status.

Role B: Travel arranger: explain that a traveler expects a new ticket and ask what happens next.

Possible opening: Our earlier message said rebooked, but the record only confirms that a connection review has been opened.

Success checks

- Take responsibility for the status error.
- Distinguish a review from a confirmed ticket.
- Offer a status check without promising availability.

Add a complication: The arranger asks you to guarantee a seat on a named alternative flight without an availability check.

LESSON 05 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Ground Handling and Turnaround Performance

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

CASE

A turnaround handoff identifies an open ground-service task but does not name who accepted it.

Teach this move

State the current situation, relevant background, open task, and receiving role. Ask for acknowledgment or repeat-back of the critical item. Sending a message and transferring responsibility are not always the same thing.

Vocabulary to check: turnaround, ground handling, load sheet, ramp safety.

Model response

This ground-service task is still open. Please confirm which team has accepted it and record the status in the agreed coordination channel before we describe the handoff as complete.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised sentence asks for an identifiable receiving team instead of leaving responsibility with an unspecified 'someone'.

Second-round challenge

The intended recipient cannot take ownership. Keep the status clear and identify the need for an authorized reassignment.

Language-check answers

1. A - Please confirm who will complete the outstanding check. It asks for an identifiable person or team responsible for the task.
2. C - So the result is pending and your team will follow up; is that correct? This repeats the status and responsibility and invites correction.

05 • Conversations

1. Who owns the open service task? - Fictional turnaround handoff: a cabin-service task is open with no receiving owner; the dialogue transfers coordination only, not aircraft-release authority.
2. A provider acknowledgment without completion - Separate fictional desk case: a ground-handling provider acknowledged a service request at 14:10; completion has not been reported.
3. A document check passes to another shift - Separate fictional ground-handling exercise: two load-sheet document versions are present; an authorized document check is pending. Staff discuss ownership, not loading instructions.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 • Say it: second scenario | The receiving coordinator cannot accept

In a fictional turnaround exercise, an equipment-service request is open. The intended receiving coordinator is assigned elsewhere and cannot accept follow-up. The outgoing coordinator must request an authorized reassignment and keep ownership explicit.

Role A: Outgoing coordinator: state the open task and ask who can accept it.

Role B: Duty supervisor: acknowledge the gap and agree to seek an authorized receiving person.

Possible opening: The equipment-service request is still open, and the intended recipient cannot take the follow-up.

Success checks

- State that acceptance is missing.
- Keep current responsibility explicit until reassignment is confirmed.
- Avoid equating message delivery with an accepted handoff.

Add a complication: Someone suggests marking the handoff complete because the message was sent.

LESSON 06 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Security and Access Control

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

CASE

A visitor asks a staff member to bypass an access check because a meeting is running late.

Teach this move

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Vocabulary to check: secure area, badge, escort, audit.

Model response

I understand the meeting is urgent, but access still needs to follow the approved process. Let me contact the authorized team to arrange the appropriate check and escort if required.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Second-round challenge

The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Language-check answers

1. C - Send it no later than Thursday. 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.
2. B - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review? The requested action and information are explicit.

05 · Conversations

1. A late meeting does not bypass access checks - Fictional landside reception exercise: a contractor asks to bypass a secure-area access check because a meeting is late; no access procedure details are taught.
2. An unreadable badge needs the proper check - Separate fictional reception case: a visiting technician's badge cannot be read by reception; access has not been authorized.

3. Request the access audit evidence securely - Separate fictional administrative case: an internal audit needs access-check records for a defined training sample; no personal records are shared in the dialogue.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | An escort arrangement is only proposed

A fictional meeting host has requested an escort for a visitor, but no escort has accepted. The visitor is waiting outside the secure area. Ask the host for a confirmed arrangement while preserving the applicable access process.

Role A: Reception officer: request escort confirmation and explain the current waiting status.

Role B: Meeting host: acknowledge that requesting an escort is not confirmation and contact the authorized coordinator.

Possible opening: Could you confirm who has accepted the escort request? The visitor is still waiting at reception.

Success checks

- State that the escort is not confirmed.
- Reject bypassing the access process clearly.
- Agree who will obtain an authorized arrangement.

Add a complication: The host asks the visitor to enter behind an arriving employee.

LESSON 07 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Incident Reporting and Investigation

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

CASE

An initial incident note says equipment damage was caused by a specific action, although the review is incomplete.

Teach this move

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

Vocabulary to check: incident report, damage assessment, root cause, corrective action.

Model response

The damage has been observed; its cause is still under review. I'll record the known sequence and distinguish witness reports from confirmed findings in the note.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Second-round challenge

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Language-check answers

1. B - The change may have contributed to the delay. 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.
2. A - In this pilot, the observed result was ... This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

05 • Conversations

1. A dent does not establish its cause - Fictional incident-review exercise: equipment damage is observed, but the investigation has not established the action that caused it.
2. Two witness accounts are not one finding - Separate fictional investigation case: two witnesses describe a vehicle's position differently; neither account has been reconciled with available records.

3. No further reports is not proof of effectiveness - Separate fictional follow-up case: a corrective briefing was delivered last week and no similar incident reports have arrived; effectiveness has not been evaluated.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A photograph lacks timing

A fictional incident review includes a photograph showing equipment damage, but the capture time is unverified. A manager wants to say it proves the damage existed before the shift. Discuss a more accurate statement and the next evidence check.

Role A: Investigation coordinator: describe what the photograph shows and what it cannot establish yet.

Role B: Operations manager: ask which record could help verify the timing.

Possible opening: The photograph shows damage, but its unverified timing does not establish when that damage occurred.

Success checks

- Separate visible damage from unknown timing.
- Preserve the original evidence without inventing metadata.
- Agree a verification request without assigning blame.

Add a complication: Someone offers to label the photograph with the assumed time for convenience.

LESSON 08 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Regulatory Audits and Readiness

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

CASE

An audit preparation list has current records for most staff but three records still need verification.

Teach this move

Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

Vocabulary to check: audit, training record, compliance, corrective action.

Model response

Most records have been checked; three remain unverified. I'll list those items, their owners, and the follow-up status so the audit update shows the outstanding work clearly.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision gives observable progress. A positive label alone does not tell the reader what is complete or still needed.

Second-round challenge

The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Language-check answers

1. A - The team has completed the review. 'Has completed' states that the action is finished.
2. C - Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it. This explicitly labels the date as planned and identifies the missing confirmation.

05 · Conversations

1. Three training records remain unverified - Fictional audit-readiness meeting: most staff records are current in the preparation list, but three training records still need verification.
2. An uploaded procedure is not a completed evidence review - Separate fictional audit case: a revised procedure is uploaded; staff acknowledgment evidence remains incomplete. The dialogue does not establish regulatory

compliance.

3. Implemented corrective action awaits verification - Separate fictional audit follow-up: a corrective action has been implemented, but the assigned verification review is not finished.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | The sample period is incomplete

A fictional audit request covers April through June. April and May training-check records have been verified; June records are retrieved but not reviewed. Give a readiness update and agree ownership of the remaining review.

Role A: Records coordinator: state the completed months and the precise June status.

Role B: Audit manager: ask what is missing before describing the sample as verified.

Possible opening: April and May are verified; June records are available, but their review is still open.

Success checks

- Distinguish retrieval from verification.
- Identify June as the open portion.
- Agree review ownership without inventing a completion date.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to call all three months complete because the files are in the folder.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

Workplace coordination English. This course does not teach radiotelephony phraseology or certify aviation language proficiency; operational communication follows approved aviation procedures.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

FAA: aviation English standard

https://www.faa.gov/regulations_policies/advisory_circulars/index.cfm/go/document.information/documentID/1031388

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.